

The Coca-Cola Company

4Q24 First Impressions

KO just reported 4Q24 Comparable EPS of \$0.55 that bested us and Consensus at \$0.52. This was a clean, top-line-led beat that flowed through the P&L favorably.

Our Thoughts

In a rare turn of events this earnings season, KO posted a strong beat to both top & bottom line and offered earnings guidance that is comfortably in-line with Consensus estimates (even with a higher tax rate & FX headwind than anticipated). Organic sales were +14% or +11%, using unit case volume which was 1% ahead of our model. Revenue outperformance was across all geographies, and in particular, it would seem recovery in both the Middle East and China played a part. North America continued to benefit from outsized growth in fairlife as implied by very strong price/mix. Profitability was also strong across gross & operating margins and FCF was well ahead of guidance, albeit with some timing effects.

Highlights

- Organic sales +14% vs. our +7%, with ~65% of the beat stemming from concentrate and the balance price/mix
- Selling day impacts as expected (2 points) but vs our model, concentrate timing was a 1.5 point benefit
- UCV +2% vs. our +1%
- Gross margins +160 bps vs. our +80 bps, partially offset by stronger reinvestment but operating margins still outperformed by ~25 bps
- FY24 FCF ex IRS litigation payment of \$10.8bn vs. \$9.2bn guide (BARCe \$9.3bn)

Lowlights

- EMEA operating margin -350 bps vs. our -90 bps
- APAC operating margin -300 bps vs. our +15 bps

2025 Guidance

Issued:

- Organic revenue +5-6% (vs. our +6.7% & Consensus at +5.9%)
- Comparable constant currency EPS +8-10%
- Comparable EPS +2-3% that implies \$2.94-\$2.97 (vs. our \$2.93 and Consensus \$2.95)
- Slight structural headwind on net revenues and comparable EPS
- Effective tax rate 20.8%, not including impact of ongoing tax litigation
- Free cash flow of ~\$9.5 billion that excludes fairlife contingent consideration
 - CFFO of \$11.7 billion, excluding fairlife payment
 - Capex of \$2.2 billion

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KO	OVERWEIGHT
U.S. CHPC & Beverages	NEUTRAL
Price Target	USD 66.00
Price (10-Feb-25)	USD 64.55
Potential Upside/Downside	+2.2%
Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research	

U.S. CHPC & Beverages

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BCI, US

- FX headwind of 3-4% on net revenues (from LSD & vs. our -2.3% & Consensus -2.6%) and a 6-7% drag on comparable EPS (from ~MSD% and vs. our -5.3%) based on current rates and including hedged positions

1Q25 Guidance

- Net revenue headwinds: FX 3-4% (our -3.6%); structural 2-3% (our -3.6%)
- Comparable EPS headwinds: FX 5-6%; structural 2-3%
- 2 fewer sell days in 1Q25

KO 4Q24 Earnings Call Details:

Today @ 8:30 AM ET - U.S. Dial: 1-888-415-4465; International: 1-646-960-0140; Passcode: 6819315.

As always, please feel free to call with any questions or comments.

Best,

Lauren

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The Coca-Cola Company (KO, 10-Feb-2025, USD 64.55), Overweight/Neutral, A/CD/CE/D/E/J/K/L/M/N

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Overweight - The stock is expected to outperform the unweighted expected total return of the industry coverage universe over a 12-month investment horizon.

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U.S. CHPC & Beverages

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Coca-Cola Europacific Partners plc (CCE.AS)	Coca-Cola Europacific Partners plc (CCEP)	Colgate-Palmolive (CL)
Constellation Brands (STZ)	Coty Inc. (COTY)	Edgewell Personal Care Company (EPC)
Energizer Holdings, Inc (ENR)	International Flavors & Fragrances (IFF)	Kenvue Inc. (KVUE)
Keurig Dr Pepper (KDP)	Kimberly-Clark Corp. (KMB)	Molson Coors Beverage Company (TAP)

Newell Brands Inc. (NWL)	ODDITY Tech Ltd. (ODD)	Olaplex Holdings, Inc. (OLPX)
PepsiCo Inc. (PEP)	Procter & Gamble (PG)	Reynolds Consumer Products (REYN)
The Coca-Cola Company (KO)	The Estée Lauder Companies (EL)	

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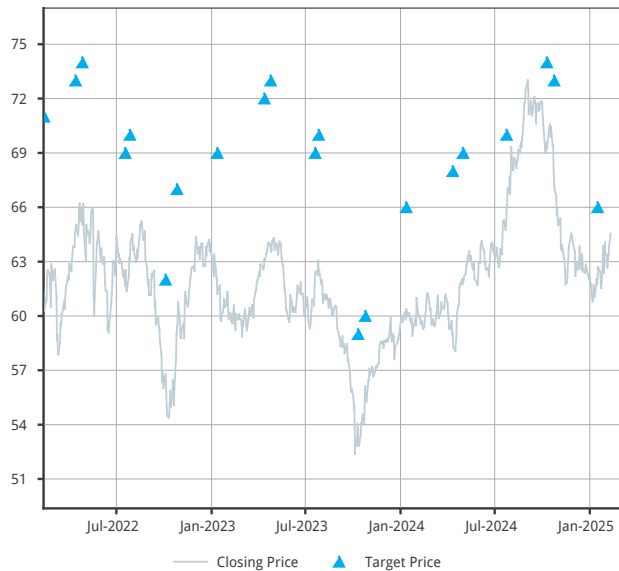
Stock Rating: **OVERWEIGHT**

Industry View: **NEUTRAL**

Closing Price: **USD 64.55** (10-Feb-2025)

Rating and Price Target Chart - USD (as of 10-Feb-2025)

Currency=USD



Source: IDC, Barclays Research

[Link to Barclays Live for interactive charting](#)

Publication Date	Closing Price*	Rating	Adjusted Price Target
16-Jan-2025	61.77		66.00
24-Oct-2024	68.01		73.00
10-Oct-2024	69.57		74.00
24-Jul-2024	64.96		70.00
01-May-2024	61.77		69.00
11-Apr-2024	59.72		68.00
12-Jan-2024	59.81		66.00
25-Oct-2023	55.64		60.00
11-Oct-2023	54.03		59.00
27-Jul-2023	63.05		70.00
20-Jul-2023	61.64		69.00
25-Apr-2023	63.95		73.00
13-Apr-2023	62.69		72.00
12-Jan-2023	61.21		69.00
26-Oct-2022	58.95		67.00
04-Oct-2022	56.78		62.00
27-Jul-2022	63.21		70.00
18-Jul-2022	61.65		69.00
26-Apr-2022	65.94		74.00
13-Apr-2022	64.73		73.00

On 11-Feb-2022, prior to any intra-day change that may have been published, the rating for this security was Overweight, and the adjusted price target was 71.00.

Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

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Valuation Methodology: Our price target of \$66 is based on a ~22.5x P/E reflecting a +25% premium to Large-Cap Staples peers on our CY25 EPS estimate of \$2.93.

Risks which May Impede the Achievement of the Barclays Research Valuation and Price Target: 1) FX headwinds force downward revision of estimates, 2) Slowdown in CSD category growth, 3) More sugar taxes cloud the dialogue, 4) Deterioration in North American pricing environment would hurt results

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